# Antonio Villani

Department of Economics and Business
Universitat Pompeu Fabra
Ramon Trias Fargas 25–27
08005 Barcelona, Spain

**Email:** antonio.villani@upf.edu
**Website:** antoniovillani.eu
**LinkedIn:** linkedin.com/in/antonio-villani-98it

## Education

**PhD Candidate in Economics**, Universitat Pompeu Fabra 2022–2027 (expected)
Advisors: Priit Jeenas and Jordi Galí

**Master of Research in Economics** (2nd year, PhD track), Universitat Pompeu Fabra 2021–2022

**MSc in Economics and Finance** (1st year, PhD track), Barcelona School of Economics 2020–2021

**BA(Econ)(Hons) Economics and Philosophy**, The University of Manchester 2017–2020
First Class Honours.
Thesis: "A defence of Salmon's Neo-Russellianism" (philosophy of language and logic).

## Research Fields

Macroeconomics, Financial Economics, Monetary Economics, Firm Dynamics

## References

**Priit Jeenas**
Assistant Professor
Universitat Pompeu Fabra

**Jordi Galí**
Senior Researcher
CREi

**Jan Eeckhout**
ICREA Research Professor
Universitat Pompeu Fabra

**Dmitry Kuvshinov**
Associate Professor
Universitat Pompeu Fabra

## Job Market Paper

**The Effects of Corporate Purchase Programmes on Market Power** [Draft]

Does unconventional monetary policy affect the market power of firms? I address this question both empirically and theoretically. Comparing firms purchased under the European Central Bank's Corporate Sector Purchase Programme with eligible but unpurchased ones in a staggered difference-in-differences design, I show that a purchase raises a firm's markups by 7.1 percent. The transmission channel runs from issuing conditions to capital: purchased bonds are issued at a 22 basis point lower yield to maturity, and purchased firms invest 2.2 percentage points more. These effects materialise only under two conditions: purchases must be repeated over the years, and they must happen within a week of the bond issuance. A general equilibrium model rationalises these findings, combining endogenous markups and financial frictions. In a segmented bond market, a purchase raises the price of the very issue it absorbs, relaxes the issuer's capital constraint, and thus raises its output, market share and markup. A quantitative version compares different purchase designs: several, including the ECB's own with its deviations from market neutrality, deliver almost the same welfare gain, while concentrating purchases on a few large firms or directing them to the smallest eligible ones reduces it.

## Work in Progress

**Synthetic Risk Transfers: Effects on Financial Fragility and Redistribution** (with Gabriela Araujo)

**Quantitative Easing in a Currency Union** (with Antonio Giribaldi and Iginio Marchesini Reggiani)

## Conferences and Seminars

**2026** BSE PhD Jamboree; BSE Summer Forum (Financial Shocks, Channels and Macro Outcomes Workshop); International Ioannina Meeting on Applied Economics and Finance; SED Annual Meeting; EEA-ESEM Congress

**2025** CREi Macro Lunch Seminar (Universitat Pompeu Fabra); Catalan Economic Society Congress; PhD Meetings in Economics; Madrid Mountain Macro Conference (poster); Naples School of Economics Workshop; Simposio de la Asociación Española de Economía

**2024** CREi Macro Lunch Seminar (Universitat Pompeu Fabra); Imperial College PhD Conference in Economics and Finance; BSE PhD Jamboree

**2023** CREi Macro Lunch Seminar (Universitat Pompeu Fabra)

## Teaching Experience

**Barcelona School of Economics – Graduate Courses**

*Teaching Assistant for:*

"Advanced Macroeconomics III" (PhD track) — 2023, 2024, 2025
Professors: Jordi Galí and Priit Jeenas

**Universitat Pompeu Fabra – Undergraduate Courses**

*Teaching Assistant for:*

"Macroeconomics I" — 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025
Professors: Isaac Baley and Davide Debortoli

## Research and Professional Experience

**Research Assistant** – Prof. Jan Eeckhout, Universitat Pompeu Fabra — 2026–2027

**Research Assistant** – Prof. Priit Jeenas, Barcelona School of Economics — Nov 2021–Jul 2023

## Additional Coursework

**2024** Difference-in-Differences and Event Study Estimators with Panel Data (by Jeffrey Wooldridge) – EABCN

## Awards and Scholarships

GPEFM PhD Track Fellowship, Universitat Pompeu Fabra — 2021–2026
Dean Award for Achievement, The University of Manchester — 2020
Stellify Award, The University of Manchester — 2020
BA(Econ) Economics and other Social Sciences Second Year Prize, The University of Manchester — 2019
Czeslaw Lejewski Logic Second Year Prize, The University of Manchester — 2019
Gold Manchester Leadership Programme, The University of Manchester — 2019

## Languages and Technical Skills

**Languages:** Italian (native), English (fluent), Spanish (proficient), Greek (basic), Catalan (basic)

**Software and Programming:** MATLAB (advanced), R (advanced), Stata (advanced), LaTeX (advanced), Julia (intermediate), Python (basic)